

Men's Ballon d'Or

France Football created the Ballon d'Or in 1956. Eligibility rules changed over time: the award was initially limited to European players, opened to players of any nationality at European clubs in 1995, and became fully global in 2007. From 2010 through 2015 it was presented jointly with FIFA.

Men's Ballon d'Or winners, 1956 to present

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date
2025	Ousmane Dembélé	France	22 September 2025
2024	Rodri	Spain	28 October 2024
2023	Lionel Messi	Argentina	30 October 2023
2022	Karim Benzema	France	17 October 2022
2021	Lionel Messi	Argentina	29 November 2021
2020	Not awarded	—	—
2019	Lionel Messi	Argentina	2 December 2019
2018	Luka Modrić	Croatia	3 December 2018
2017	Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	7 December 2017

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date
2016	Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	12 December 2016
2015	Lionel Messi	Argentina	11 January 2016
2014	Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	12 January 2015
2013	Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	13 January 2014
2012	Lionel Messi	Argentina	7 January 2013
2011	Lionel Messi	Argentina	9 January 2012
2010	Lionel Messi	Argentina	10 January 2011
2009	Lionel Messi	Argentina	1 December 2009
2008	Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	2 December 2008
2007	Kaká	Brazil	2 December 2007
2006	Fabio Cannavaro	Italy	27 November 2006
2005	Ronaldinho	Brazil	28 November 2005
2004	Andriy Shevchenko	Ukraine	13 December 2004
2003	Pavel Nedvěd	Czech Republic	22 December 2003
2002	Ronaldo	Brazil	12 December 2002
2001	Michael Owen	England	18 December 2001

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date
2000	Luís Figo	Portugal	19 December 2000
1999	Rivaldo	Brazil	21 December 1999
1998	Zinedine Zidane	France	22 December 1998
1997	Ronaldo	Brazil	23 December 1997
1996	Matthias Sammer	Germany	24 December 1996
1995	George Weah	Liberia	26 December 1995
1994	Hristo Stoichkov	Bulgaria	20 December 1994
1993	Roberto Baggio	Italy	28 December 1993
1992	Marco van Basten	Netherlands	22 December 1992
1991	Jean-Pierre Papin	France	24 December 1991
1990	Lothar Matthäus	West Germany	25 December 1990
1989	Marco van Basten	Netherlands	26 December 1989
1988	Marco van Basten	Netherlands	27 December 1988
1987	Ruud Gullit	Netherlands	29 December 1987
1986	Igor Belanov	Soviet Union	30 December 1986
1985	Michel Platini	France	24 December 1985

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date
1984	Michel Platini	France	25 December 1984
1983	Michel Platini	France	27 December 1983
1982	Paolo Rossi	Italy	28 December 1982
1981	Karl-Heinz Rummenigge	West Germany	29 December 1981
1980	Karl-Heinz Rummenigge	West Germany	30 December 1980
1979	Kevin Keegan	England	25 December 1979
1978	Kevin Keegan	England	27 December 1978
1977	Allan Simonsen	Denmark	27 December 1977
1976	Franz Beckenbauer	West Germany	28 December 1976
1975	Oleg Blokhin	Soviet Union	30 December 1975
1974	Johan Cruyff	Netherlands	31 December 1974
1973	Johan Cruyff	Netherlands	25 December 1973
1972	Franz Beckenbauer	West Germany	26 December 1972
1971	Johan Cruyff	Netherlands	28 December 1971
1970	Gerd Müller	West Germany	29 December 1970
1969	Gianni Rivera	Italy	23 December 1969

Year	Winner	National team	Ceremony date
1968	George Best	Northern Ireland	24 December 1968
1967	Flórián Albert	Hungary	26 December 1967
1966	Bobby Charlton	England	27 December 1966
1965	Eusébio	Portugal	28 December 1965
1964	Denis Law	Scotland	22 December 1964
1963	Lev Yashin	Soviet Union	17 December 1963
1962	Josef Masopust	Czechoslovakia	18 December 1962
1961	Omar Sívori	Italy	12 December 1961
1960	Luis Suárez	Spain	13 December 1960
1959	Alfredo Di Stéfano	Spain	15 December 1959
1958	Raymond Kopa	France	16 December 1958
1957	Alfredo Di Stéfano	Spain	17 December 1957
1956	Stanley Matthews	England	18 December 1956

Champions by titles

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

Lionel Messi 	8
2009, 2010, 2011, 2012, 2015, 2019, 2021, 2023	
Cristiano Ronaldo 	5
2008, 2013, 2014, 2016, 2017	
Johan Cruyff 	3
1971, 1973, 1974	
Michel Platini 	3
1983, 1984, 1985	
Marco van Basten 	3
1988, 1989, 1992	
Alfredo Di Stéfano 	2
1957, 1959	
Franz Beckenbauer 	2
1972, 1976	
Kevin Keegan 	2
1978, 1979	
Karl-Heinz Rummenigge 	2
1980, 1981	

Ronaldo  1997, 2002	2
Stanley Matthews  1956	1
Raymond Kopa  1958	1
Luis Suárez  1960	1
Omar Sívori  1961	1
Josef Masopust  1962	1
Lev Yashin  1963	1
Denis Law  1964	1
Eusébio  1965	1

Bobby Charlton  1966	1
Flórián Albert  1967	1
George Best  1968	1
Gianni Rivera  1969	1
Gerd Müller  1970	1
Oleg Blokhin  1975	1
Allan Simonsen  1977	1
Paolo Rossi  1982	1
Igor Belanov  1986	1

Ruud Gullit  1987	1
Lothar Matthäus  1990	1
Jean-Pierre Papin  1991	1
Roberto Baggio  1993	1
Hristo Stoichkov  1994	1
George Weah  1995	1
Matthias Sammer  1996	1
Zinedine Zidane  1998	1
Rivaldo  1999	1

Luís Figo  2000	1
Michael Owen  2001	1
Pavel Nedvěd  2003	1
Andriy Shevchenko  2004	1
Ronaldinho  2005	1
Fabio Cannavaro  2006	1
Kaká  2007	1
Luka Modrić  2018	1
Karim Benzema  2022	1

Rodri

1

2024

Ousmane Dembélé

1

2025



Notes

- Lev Yashin remains the only goalkeeper to win the men's award.
- George Weah became the first African winner in 1995.
- Luka Modrić won in 2018.
- The 2020 award was cancelled.
- Ousmane Dembélé won the 2025 award.



References & review

Status: review

Last reviewed: 13 August 2026

- Official winners and rankings (<https://ballondor.com/all-rankings>).
- Official homepage (<https://ballondor.com/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.rsssf.org/miscellaneous/europa-poy65.html>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.britannica.com/topic/Ballon-dOr>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.jeuneafrique.com/381505/politique/jour-26-dece-mbre-1995-george-weah-elu-ballon-dor/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.voanews.com/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.uefa.com/uefachampionsleague/news/>).

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.